

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

(PLEASE PRINT OR TYPE. ATTACH PHOTOGRAPHS, DRAWINGS AND ADDITIONAL PAGES AS NECESSARY)

SPECIES: Lesser Black-Backed Gull Larus fuscus
(Common Name) (Scientific Name)DATE(S) OF OBSERVATION: 10/21/00NUMBER OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: ? PLUMAGE: Adult NonbreedingEXACT LOCATION: West shore of Baseline ReservoirCOUNTY: Boulder NEAREST TOWN: Boulder ELEVATION: 5349 ft.LENGTH OF OBSERVATION: Ten Minutes TIME(S) OF OBSERVATION: About 3 p.m.

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO SAW THE BIRD(S) WITH YOU:

Jim Schmoker

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO INDEPENDENTLY SAW THE BIRD(S):

Several reported on COBirds

LIGHT CONDITIONS (QUALITY; DIRECTION RELATIVE TO BIRD(S); POSITION):

Light at our backs, sunny.

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT USED:

7X42 binoculars

DISTANCE FROM BIRD (ESTIMATED UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED): 20 yardsWAS BIRD PHOTOGRAPHED? no IF SO, HAVE YOU SUBMITTED PHOTOS? _____

WHO TOOK THE PHOTOGRAPHS? _____

DESCRIBE THE GENERAL AND SPECIFIC HABITAT IN WHICH THE BIRD(S) OCCURRED:

Rocky shoreline used often by California, Ring-billed, and Herring Gulls

DESCRIBE THE BIRD'S BEHAVIOR (FLYING; FEEDING; HABITS; BEHAVIORS USED IN IDENTIFYING THE SPECIES OR IN SUPPORTING THE IDENTIFICATION):

Flew in with other gulls, landed among Ring-Billed, Herring and California Gulls. Stood among them for about ten minutes before gulls flushed and flew back over the lake.

DESCRIBE THE BIRD IN DETAIL. THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT PART OF THIS REPORT. INCLUDE THE OVERALL SIZE AND SHAPE AND HOW YOU PLACED THE BIRD IN THE GENERAL GROUP THAT YOU DID. GIVE COMPLETE DETAILS OF PLUMAGE, INCLUDING HEAD, THROAT, UNDERSIDES, NAPE, BACK, WINGS AND TAIL. GIVE PARTICULAR EMPHASIS TO MARKS YOU USED TO IDENTIFY THE BIRD(S). DESCRIBE OTHER DETAILS, SUCH AS COLOR AND SHAPE OF BILL, LEGS, EYE, ETC. THAT WERE IMPORTANT IN MAKING THE IDENTIFICATION. (FILL OUT THIS PORTION EVEN IF PHOTOGRAPHS ARE SUBMITTED; YOU MAY ATTACH ADDITIONAL SHEETS, DRAWINGS, FIELD SKETCHES OR COPY OF FIELD NOTES):

Overall dark tops of wings drew my eyes to the bird initially. It was flying in with several ring-billed gulls with far lighter wing tops. When it landed the darker mantle contrasted sharply with the ring-bills, californias, and herring gulls already there. Got a clear look at its head as it stood there- all yellow bill except for a large oval bright red spot on its mandible. Couldn't see its legs in the crowd but had a good size comparison- bigger than the ring-bills and smaller than the herring gulls. Quite similar in size to the californias in the group.

DESCRIBE BIRD'S CALL OR SONG:

N/A

DISCUSS SIMILAR SPECIES AND HOW YOU ELIMINATED THEM:

See above.

WHAT IS YOUR PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES?

First L. Black-backed I have seen- I've seen thousands of the other three species present.

LIST BOOKS, GUIDES, RECORDINGS OR OTHER SOURCES CONSULTED AND HOW THIS INFLUENCED YOUR IDENTIFICATION (DURING AND AFTER OBSERVATION):

Sibley, National Geographic

THIS REPORT WAS MADE FROM NOTES MADE DURING ____ OR AFTER X OBSERVATION, OR LATER FROM MEMORY ____.

DATE OF WRITTEN REPORT: 12/08/00

REPORTING OBSERVER: William P. Schmoker SIGNATURE: 

OBSERVER ADDRESS:

2227 Canyon Blvd. #106

Boulder, CO 80302

SEND REPORT TO:

COLORADO BIRD RECORDS COMMITTEE

c/o BILL LISOWSKY

1059 PLEASANT HILL CHURCH RD.

CADIZ, KY 42211